

Food chains

Each plant and animal depends on other living things around it to survive. Some animals eat plants, and others eat other animals. Nutrients from droppings and rotting material go into the soil and are used by plants.

Who eats what?

All animals are split into four categories, based on what they eat. These are **decomposers**, **omnivores**, **herbivores**, and **carnivores**.

The sun is at the start of this food chain. Sunlight is the main source of energy for plants.

Plants use the energy in sunlight to produce food. They use this food to grow leaves, flowers, fruit, and seeds.

Animals that eat only plants are called herbivores. Energy passes from plants to the animals that eat them.

Apex predator

An **apex predator** is at the top of every food chain. Apex predators are powerful enough not to be eaten by any other animal. The grizzly bear and the great white shark are both apex predators.



Grizzly bear



Great white shark

Animals that hunt and eat other animals are called **predators**.